ii) Legal Obligation: Our nation is a welfare state where the Government focuses on providing us with the infrastructural facilities. Roads, health centres, hospitals, education, etc are few of the examples of concern.

iii) Positive Obligation: There are certain rules made by the state which cannot be disobeyed and hence they are considered as the positive obligation. For examples, paying tax and serving the defence.

iv) Negative Obligation: This is the direct opposite of positive obligation. Here, an individual is not permissible to do what the government prevents him from doing so. Commission of crime is also a negative obligation.

Which are your obligations to the state?

- Playing with your friends.
- Cast votes during the election time.
- Teaching your sister.
- Payment of taxes to the state.
- To join the Public Service.
- To serve the army during emergency time.

The Constitution and important obligations

There are situations where some laws are framed by the Government which are harmful and yet they get a support, which is called the Steam roller legislature. It is the duty of the citizen to resist such laws too. Hence, the concept of political obligation not only informs people to obey the rules and regulations of the authority of power but also informs to resist if the laws are found not to be good for the society.

Theories of Political Obligation

All of us have some theories, values in life. In the same way, theories are applicable for political obligations too. There are different types of theories of political obligation.

i. The Divine theory

In the olden days, people thought that the God created the state and the king was his representative. But this theory could be popular only during the ancient and middle ages but not during the modern era.

ii. The Consent Theory

This theory proposes that the authority of the state is based on the people's consent. **Hobbes, Locke** and **Rousseau** justified this theory on the grounds that the authority of power was dependent on the people's consent. But, later it could not be accepted because it treated state as an artificial organisation.

iii. The Prescriptive Theory

This theory states that political institutions are continuous from the past, this idea has been supported by **Edmund Burke.** But over a period of time, it lost its effect due to its overemphasis on the respect for the well-established practices.

iv. The Idealistic Theory



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